

Duc Nguyen

Artist research statement Group

Looking back into the perspective of Group, I want to create a poster and pins that reflect the three core values that lie under the Group perspective: Collaboration, Common Purpose, and Controversy with Civility. I understand that my posters and pins might not be able to tackle all three equally, but I still want to include all of them to the best of my ability. My works are two different design posters and one pin design. I printed seven 11x17 posters and two enlarged ones for the first poster design. The second poster design will be three 11x17 posters. Finally, I create pins that go alongside the posters I create.

In this project, I want to explore my design skill while still keeping up with the styles from my previous project. Here, I try to keep my first and second project fit with each other through the color palette, humor, and sarcastic tone company my cartoonist drawing while adapting the dark black uneven border of the Pro Choice, Figh Rape, Fight Racism poster in Graphic Agitation 1 book. I also like how the poster centers the main image in the middle and uses multiple colors for its call to action. However, their choice of color for the poster words was different from what I wanted, so I decided to play with it more with my color palette.

The first poster designs show how the Bi community should/are proud of their sexuality while comedically shaming other people's ignorance. The second one acts as an affirmation toward the Bi sexuality. Both use humor not as a way to humiliate something but as a way to show the Bi community is confident to make fun of our sexuality innocently. The humor is not about stereotypes of the Bi community but affirming our sexuality or telling people to educate themselves before speaking about the Bi community. Here, I want to show the Controversy with

Civility values through confrontation. In my first project, I already show my action to create a connection with other groups through personal experience. That is why in this project, I do not want to be "agreeable" with people rejecting Bisexuality. Despite recognizing different viewpoints toward sexuality, I want my posters to stand up and say that people need to be educated and accept that Bisexuality is valid, and no argument should be made that contradicts this.

With the pins that accompany the poster, I want to create something that keeps up with the poster's humorous tone and color palette while adding a different graphic to make them unique. While I understand the need to make the posters and the pins feel like they belong to each other, I also want my pins to be able to work as a separate entity that speaks for itself too. The pun is not just a humorous slogan but also acts to empower the Bisexuality community. The pins represent the Collaboration and the Common Purpose value, using its wearer to empower the Bi community. I use the phrase "Strong Bi-Fi" so people other than the Bi community can also wear it. The phrase is not telling people that its wearer is Bi, so they can make justifications if they want, but just suggesting someone near is Bi, so allies, families, or friends can also wear it to support their Bisexual "person."